"…Democracy means that nobody has any perpetual authority to rule, but that rule is subject to sanction by the people and can be challenged in the House* itself. You will see how important it is to have an opposition. Opposition means the government is always on the anvil. The government must justify every act that it does to those of the people who do not belong to its party."

BR Ambedkar, 1948

The Indian National Congress was the dominant political organization of the independence movement. During those turbulent years, the party came to include several factions or groups within it, with differing beliefs but united by the goal of a free nation. However, these factions and their charismatic leaders often had opposing ideas of what that free nation should look like and how to work towards it. They also differed on how India's government should be structured and what its responsibilities should be.

After 1947, several of these groups broke away and formed separate political parties. Over time, other parties that represented different social or religious groups or whose members were united by specific goals also came to exist. Often, the members of these parties were dissatisfied with or disagreed with the Congress on major